

Standard Operating Procedure

High-Risk Obstetric Case Identification and Management

«Hospital Name» — Supports COP.10.b

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» identifies a high-risk pregnancy during ante-natal care and manages it in-house or by timely referral.

2. Scope

Applies to every ante-natal patient assessed at any visit.

3. Responsibility

Obstetrician / Ante-Natal Doctor: identifies high-risk factors and decides in-house management or referral.

4. Procedure

1. Apply the hospital's defined high-risk criteria at every ante-natal visit — this is not limited to the first visit.
2. Document the specific risk factor identified and the visit/date it was found.
3. For conditions within the hospital's scope, confirm a competent workforce and facilities are actually available before managing in-house.
4. For conditions outside scope, refer promptly to an appropriate facility and document the referral.
5. Increase monitoring frequency for every identified high-risk case, per written guidance.

5. Records

Supported by Records 3 and 4 of the COP.10 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_COP_10_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — COP.10 policy
- SOP — Labour and Delivery Monitoring

7. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any maternal adverse event linked to a missed high-risk identification.

8. References

- World Health Organization. (2018). WHO Recommendations: Intrapartum Care for a Positive Childbirth Experience. <https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789241550215> — informs the risk-based care model this SOP applies.